

Impress Your Colleagues with Awesome Vim Plugins

Vim is an improved version of the Vi editor. It has evolved from its simple origins and is now a powerful cross-platform text editing tool that works from the command line and as a standalone GUI. The full potential of Vim becomes evident when using its plugins, and this article tells you how to install them.



Vim is an improved version of the Vi editor. Many Linux OSs support it by default. Vim is a lightweight, flexible and easy-to-use command line editor. Many developers do use Vim, but not always to its full potential.

Vim is much more powerful than we think. It has a variety of open source plugins that are available for free. Vim can be easily installed in your OS, for which you will need to know the basics.

For a better understanding of this article, the reader should be familiar with the basics of Linux and Vim.

Vimawesome.com provides all types of plugins. It shows the following six options:

- The first option is with regard to language, allowing you to select plugins for your language of choice.
- The second option is for completion, which gives you a plugin for code completion.
- The third option is code display, which gives you code colour display plugins.
- The fourth option is for colourful interface plugins.
- The fifth option is for commands—it gives you command related plugins.
- The sixth option provides you different utilities like a library for Vim, a plugin manager, code review, etc.

Installation

The following three different and simple steps are suggested for installing plugins for Vim.

1) Using Vundle

Clone the repository into `~/vim/bundle/` by default:

```
$ git clone https://github.com/VundleVim/Vundle.vim.git
~/vim/bundle/Vundle.vim
```

Once you clone it, set up your `~/vimrc` file, as follows:

```
set nocompatible
filetype off
set rtp+=~/vim/bundle/Vundle.vim
call vundle#begin()
# We are hadling vundle in vim. It is required for enable
plugin in vim.
Plugin 'VundleVim/Vundle.vim'
# Write plugin names here.
# Keep your plugins in between begin() and end() tag.
# you have to give git repo to install plugins. Like:
Plugin 'tpope/vim-fugitive'
# If plugin is not on github then write it as:
Plugin 'l9'
call vundle#end()
#Vundle plugin end tag
# Required for Ignore plugin indent changes.
filetype plugin indent on
```

To install the plugins, launch Vim and run *PluginInstall*. You can install the plugins using the command line:

```
$ vim +PluginInstall +qall
```

PluginInstall is for the plugin install; append `!` to the update or just click on *PluginUpdate*.

PluginList is for the plugin list. Append `!` to refresh the local cache.

PluginSearch foo is to search for the foo plugin.

PluginClean confirms the removal of unused plugins.

Append `!` for auto-removal approval.